

Bandit - Level 07

Goal

The password for the next level is stored in `data.txt`, next to the word **millionth**.

Connection

```
ssh -p 2220 bandit7@bandit.labs.overthewire.org
```

Use the password retrieved at the end of [Bandit - Level 06](#).

Concepts

`grep` searches for a pattern **inside the content** of what it receives — whether that's a file passed as an argument or data piped into it from another command. The key distinction this level forces: `grep` filters lines, not filenames.

Attempts

```
# Tried to locate the file first - unnecessary, it was already in the home directory
find / -name data.txt 2>/dev/null

# Piped find output into grep - grep was filtering file *paths*, not file *content*
find / -name data.txt | grep 'millionth' 2>/dev/null # returned nothing

# Same mistake, different stderr placement - still filtering paths
find / -name data.txt 2>/dev/null | grep 'millionth' # returned nothing
```

Solution

```
ls # data.txt is right here in the home directory
cat data.txt | grep 'millionth'
# → millionth VR1ljMayciFxbnUokuQmJFw6QC9VKtub
```

Or equivalently, passing the file directly to `grep`:

```
grep 'millionth' data.txt
```

Points of Friction

Reached for `find` first — unnecessary since `data.txt` was already in the home directory. Then piped `find` output into `grep`, which filtered file *path names* for the word "millionth" rather than the file's content. The fix was simply `cat data.txt | grep 'millionth'`, which pipes the file's content into `grep` instead.

Key Takeaway

`grep` filters the **content of lines**, not filenames or paths. When you pipe `find` into `grep`, `grep` is searching through the list of paths that `find` prints — not inside those files. To search inside a file: either `grep 'pattern' file.txt` or `cat file.txt | grep 'pattern'`. Both are equivalent; the direct form is faster.

Next

```
ssh -p 2220 bandit8@bandit.labs.overthewire.org
```

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